

RBI Cautionary Notice on Fake KYC Updation and Account Suspension SMS

Publisher: RBI | Topic: kyc_otp_fraud | Date: 2026-10-02

Official Source: https://www.rbi.org.in/scripts/BS_PressReleaseDisplay.aspx?prid=57123

Official Advisory: RBI Public Notice: Prevention of KYC Expiry and Account Freeze Scams

Common Scam Scenario: KYC Expiry Threats

Customers receive urgent SMS messages stating: 'Dear Customer, your bank account/card/SIM will be suspended within 24 hours due to incomplete KYC. Click here <http://bit.ly/bank-kyc-verify> to update immediately'. Panicked customers click the link fearing stoppage of essential banking services.

Credential Theft and Remote Screen Sharing

The phishing webpage mimics legitimate netbanking login screens, prompting for credentials, debit card CVV, and OTP. Alternatively, fraudsters call pretending to be bank customer service executives, instructing victims to install remote screen-sharing tools (such as AnyDesk, TeamViewer QuickSupport, or RustDesk) under the guise of 'assisting with video KYC'. Once granted, fraudsters view the screen and steal OTPs during unauthorized fund transfers.

Official Regulatory Stance on KYC Processes

1. Regulated entities (banks, NBFCs) never send external web links via SMS or WhatsApp for periodic KYC updates.
2. Periodic KYC updates can be completed directly through official netbanking/mobile applications or by visiting your home branch.
3. Bank officials will NEVER request remote access to customer devices or ask for OTP/PIN over phone calls.
4. Do not respond to messages received from personal mobile numbers claiming to represent bank administration.

Action on Receiving Suspicious KYC Messages

Forward unsolicited phishing SMS to 1909 (TRAI DND) or report on Sanchar Saathi Chakshu portal. Do not click links or call numbers provided in the SMS.

Citizen Action Checklist & Red Flags

- **Verify Sender Identity:** Always check official website addresses and header IDs (e.g., VM-SBI, AX-HDFC). Scammers use fake sender masks.
- **Never Share Authentication Secrets:** Passwords, OTPs, UPI PINs, and debit card CVVs are strictly confidential. Bank staff will NEVER ask for them.
- **Independent Verification:** If you receive a threat or alert about an account freeze, call the official bank branch number found on your physical card or bank statement.
- **Immediate Reporting:** Report cyber financial fraud within the Golden Hour by calling 1930 or visiting cybercrime.gov.in.

Frequently Asked Questions (Regulatory Clarifications)

Q1: Can money be deposited into my bank account by entering my UPI PIN?

A: No. A UPI PIN is solely an authorization to debit funds from your linked bank account. Receiving funds requires NO authentication or PIN entry.

Q2: What is the first action to take if money is fraudulently deducted?

A: Dial 1930 immediately to register the complaint on the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C) CFCFRMS portal so that the beneficiary account can be frozen before funds are withdrawn.

Q3: What should I do if an unknown caller threatens me with a police arrest over video call?

A: Disconnect immediately. Indian police and law enforcement agencies never issue summons, conduct investigations, or place citizens under 'Digital Arrest' via video calls.

Official Notice & Legal Status: This document is compiled for the ScamShield AI Knowledge Base from authentic public circulars, advisories, and directives issued by regulatory and enforcement authorities in India (including RBI, NPCI, I4C, MHA, SEBI, CERT-In, and DoT). All citizen rights, statutory duties, and liability ceilings are governed by relevant acts including the Information Technology Act 2000 and RBI Customer Protection Directives.